QING LI

School of Business, Hong Kong Baptist University, Kowloon Tong, Hong Kong
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Substantive: AI in salesforce management, AI–human collaboration, digital platforms, customer acquisition
Methodological: Causal inference, field experiments, machine learning

EDUCATION

Hong Kong Baptist University (HKBU) 2023–Present, Hong Kong
Ph.D. in Marketing (proposal defended Feb 2026; expected Jul 2027)

New York University 2014–2016, New York City, US
M.S. in Integrated Marketing

Northeastern University (NEU, Project 985) 2010–2014, China
B.B.A. in Marketing

JOB MARKET PAPER

"When Is Success Replicable? How Enterprise AI Turns Know-How into Scalable Sales Performance"

SELECTED WORKING PAPERS

"Artificial Intelligence as a Relational Shock: Evidence on Newcomer–Seasoned Collaboration in Sales Organizations" With Jialie Chen and Danny Wang. *Major revision, Management Science.*

"AI–Human Collaboration in Sequential Sales Funnels: Evidence from a Large-Scale Field Experiment" With Xiaolin Li, Danny Wang, and Flora Gu. *Invited to resubmit, Marketing Science.*

"Work Hard or Work Smart? Layered Artificial Intelligence and Salesperson Effort Allocation in Sales Systems" With Yijing Li, Albert Liu, Danny Wang, and Flora Gu. *Under review, Production and Operations Management.*

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Research Postgraduate Studentship, HKBU, HK$908,640	2023–2027
HKBU School of Business Scholarship, HK$20,000	2023–2027
HKBU Graduate School Scholarship, HK$20,000	2023–2027
National Scholarship, top 1% (highest scholarship of the Ministry of Education of China)	2013
First-Class Scholarship for Outstanding Students, top 1%, NEU	2010–2012

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Course Instructor, MKTG 4055 Event Marketing, HKBU — Fall 2026

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

INFORMS Marketing Science Conference, Nova SBE, Lisbon, Portugal	June 2026
Hong Kong Quant Marketing Brownbag (Online)	January 2026
HKBU Departmental Brownbag, Hong Kong	January 2026

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Ad hoc Reviewer, AMA Summer Conference, Chicago, IL	2025
Ad hoc Reviewer, AMA Winter Conference, Phoenix, AZ	2025

DATA ACCESS AND COLLECTION EXPERTISE

Proprietary dataset: Online leasing platform; TikTok video-ad field data; AI sales / CRM logs; loan data from a major Chinese commercial bank.

Web-scraped: LinkedIn profiles, Upwork profiles, Glassdoor data, Taobao reviews, Twitter posts, B Lab profiles, Kickstarter and IndieGoGo projects, Freelancer.com data, RateMyProfessor data, Goodreads data, and Album of the Year data, etc.

SELECTED DOCTORAL COURSEWORK

Empirical Marketing Research — Zemin (Zachary) Zhong (U of Toronto)	Fall 2025
Empirical Methods in Business II — Tat Chan (WashU)	Summer 2025
Structural Models and Empirical Methods — Hui Li (HKU)	Spring 2025
Advanced Topics of AI and Machine Learning — Xueming Luo (TempleU)	Summer 2024
Empirical Marketing Models — Junhong Chu (HKU)	Spring 2024
Empirical Methods in Business Modeling and Estimation — Tat Chan (WashU)	Fall 2023

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Strategy Senior Manager, TikTok (International E-commerce), Shenzhen	Dec 2022 – Nov 2023
Risk Manager, SF Express Holding (Listed: 2352.SZ, 6936.HK), Shenzhen	Nov 2020 – Dec 2022
Assistant Manager, KPMG LLP, New York City, Hong Kong	Aug 2016 – Nov 2020

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Programming: Python (scikit-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow), R, Stata, SPSS, MATLAB, LaTeX

Languages: Chinese (native); English (fluent; IELTS 8.0/9.0; GMAT 750 in 2013)

REFERENCES

Danny T. Wang (PhD Supervisor)
Associate Professor of Marketing, School of Business
Hong Kong Baptist University
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Kimmy Wa Chan (Committee Member)
Professor of Marketing, School of Business
Hong Kong Baptist University
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Professor of Strategy, Department of Strategy and Innovation
Copenhagen Business School
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ABSTRACT OF THESIS

Thesis title: Essays on AI–Human Collaboration in Sales Organizations and Customer Acquisition

This thesis studies how firms should integrate artificial intelligence into frontline selling, using large-scale field experiments and quasi-experimental designs with real sales organizations. It examines AI–human collaboration at two levels: within the customer-acquisition funnel (Essay 1) and across relationships inside the sales organization (Essay 2).

Essay 1. "AI–Human Collaboration in Sequential Sales Funnels: Evidence from a Large-Scale Field Experiment"

Firms increasingly deploy AI in frontline acquisition, but there is little causal evidence on how to integrate it into multi-stage funnels where early assessments shape later human effort. In a large commercial bank's SME-lending funnel, a conversational AI voice agent makes the initial outbound call and assigns an intention tag, after which human agents handle all follow-ups. In a randomized field experiment (N = 78,169), routing prospects to the AI-initiated channel nearly doubles the odds of loan application relative to a human-only workflow. The gains stem from human–AI collaboration rather than full automation: improvements concentrate in later human follow-ups, as AI sharpens early information capture and prospect segmentation and reallocates effort across thousands of contacts. The hybrid workflow also reduces central-tendency bias in human tagging and elicits constructive alignment with AI assessments, speaking to debates on algorithm aversion versus appreciation.

Essay 2. "Artificial Intelligence as a Relational Shock: Evidence on Newcomer–Seasoned Collaboration in Sales Organizations"

AI embedded in sales workflows—automating data processing and generating next-best-action recommendations—is now widespread, yet little is known about how it reshapes workplace relationships and cross-tenure mentoring. Using a propensity-score-matched difference-in-differences design around a randomized AI-invitation rollout, we show that AI adoption acts as a relational shock in B2B sales firms. By surfacing additional selling opportunities, AI disproportionately raises seasoned salespeople's workload and crowds out the time they devote to mentoring newcomers, with an implied collaboration-channel revenue loss of up to 23% of average weekly firm revenue. The effect is attenuated in data-sparse settings—greater activity with new customers and products—where AI generates fewer high-confidence leads requiring seasoned follow-up. The study reveals a hidden organizational cost of workflow-embedded AI and offers levers for integrating AI while preserving collaboration across experience levels.